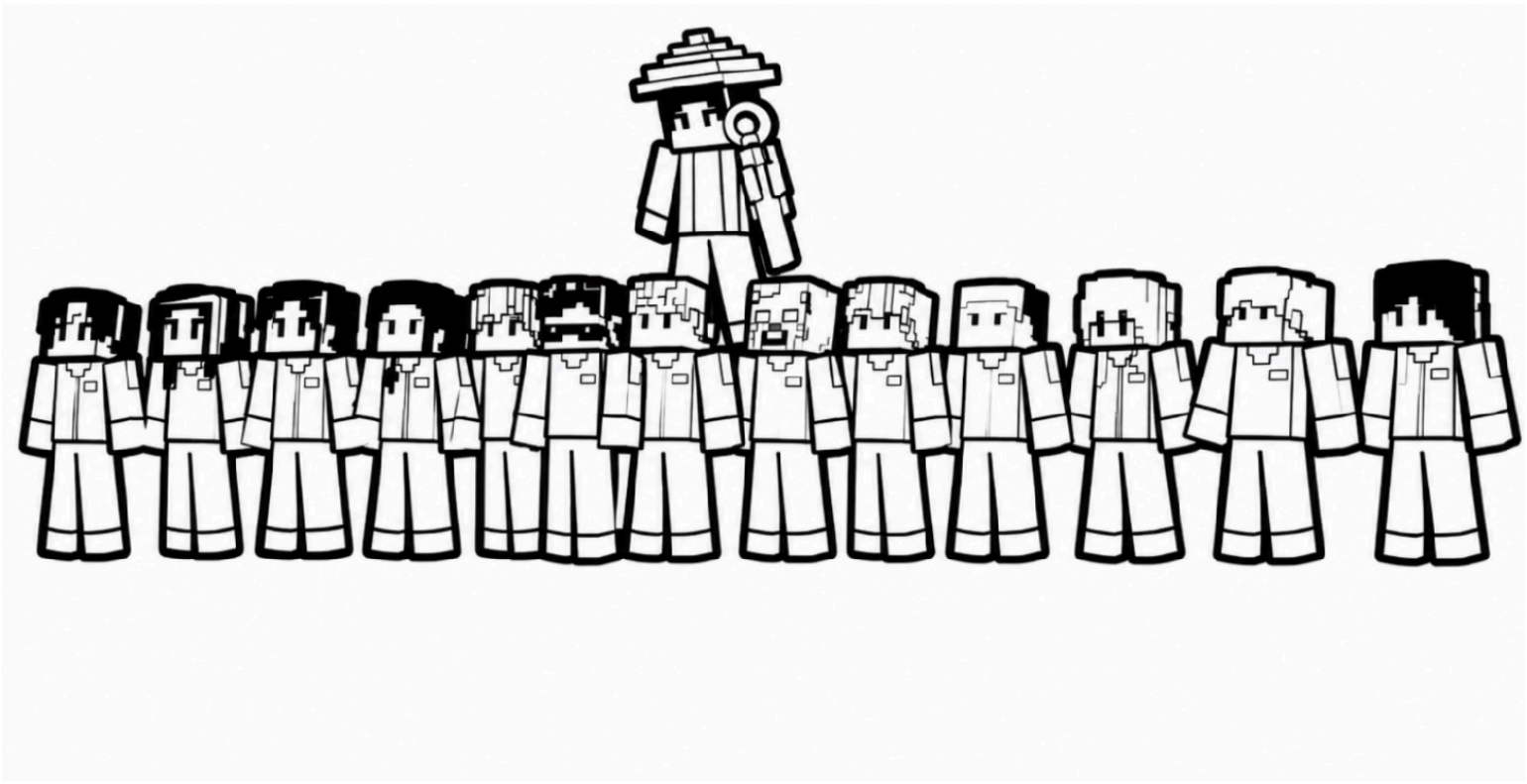
ESCAPE FROM SECTOR 42



Story adapted from the film: "Escape From Sector 42"

Written by Faricraft

Faricraft is an Argentine YouTuber who enjoys making Minecraft gameplay videos.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

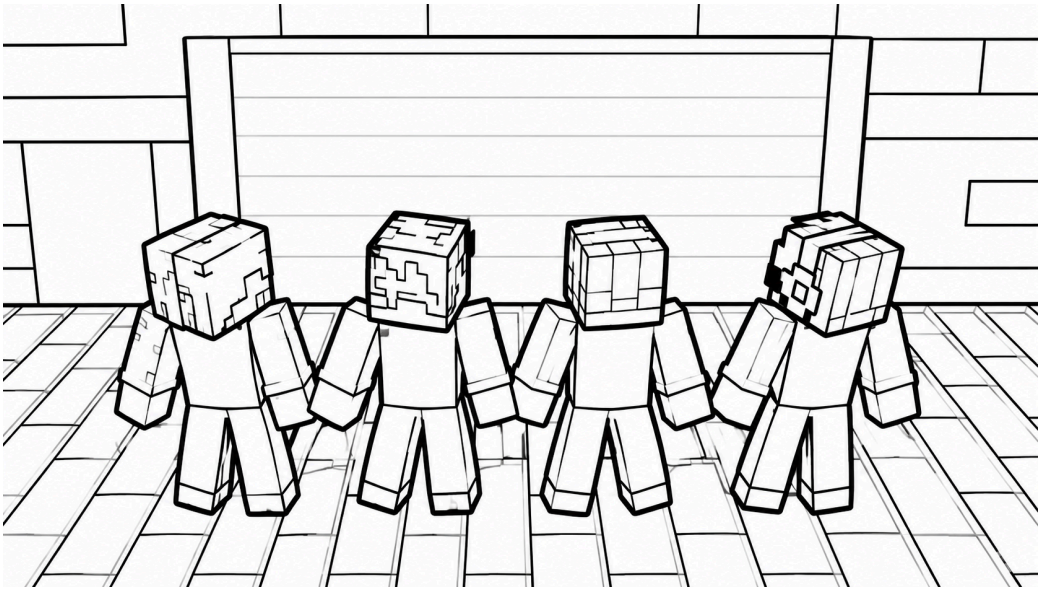
Thank you to everyone who contributed to this project and wanted to take part:

- Francisco Arangio
- Delfina Di Rocco
- Valentino Sergiani
- Martina Fidelibus
- Juana Righi Pettit
- Albertina Dautel
- Tomás Fidelibus
- Elena Menini
- Joaquina Costa
- Sara Sosa Quinteros
- Delfina Collelo
- Vicente Torres Cialdella
- Juan Martín Paz
- Santino Privitera
- Emilia Angulo
- Nicoleta Petrich Galli
- Felicitas Squeff
- Valentino Di Sipio
- Mateo Yovaldi
- Fermín Vidal
- Victoria García Jérez
- Vicky
- Josefina Maffei
- Gaspar Pieretti
- Clara Bridger
- Agustin Villagi
- Maria Clara
- Martina M.
- Catalina
- Vera
- Julieta Gomila
- Jeremías Garcia Zini
- Tomás Montero Piermatei
- Lorenzo

CHAPTER 1: THE BEGINNING

This story begins with 13 friends who went everywhere together. One day, at a bookstore, they decided to buy a book. But the person paying had no money left on his card, and none of his friends had brought any. The trouble was, he hadn't heard that there was no money in the account. He walked off with the others, who forgot to tell him. Before long, the guards came looking for him and his friends. Confused, with no idea what had happened, he woke up in PRISON. He wasn't alone: his friends were in separate cells. And by the way, that person at the beginning was me, Faricraft. So I decided to escape through a vent and dropped into a room. It wasn't a smooth landing, either. I rolled across the floor and hit a button that opened all my friends' cell doors. Then I got out of there and met up with everyone to make a plan. There were no guards in sight in the corridor, but there was a possible way out: a narrower passage full of lasers and obstacles to dodge. After we'd dodged ALMOST EVERYTHING, an iron golem appeared halfway along. But this wasn't just any golem. It was a police golem, and we couldn't kill it. Then Santino Privitera arrived. He was an experienced wizard, and he'd come prepared with his wand. He made the golem disappear, and we carried on dodging the lasers.

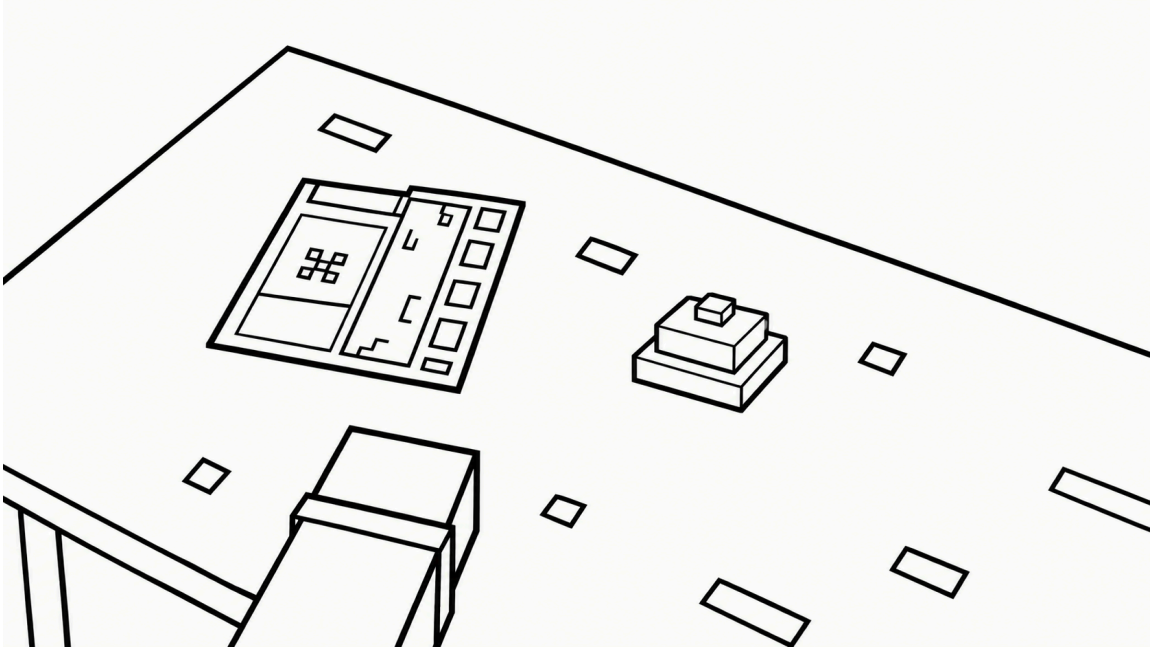
Once we were through, we ran into a large group of ZOMBIE GUARDS. We fought them for quite a while. After defeating them, we found a surprise… and it wasn't a good one. The gate at the end, beyond the zombies, WAS LOCKED. We still couldn't escape…



CHAPTER 2: THE PROBLEM

The friends thought for a while. Then Vicencraft looked at the gate and realized it wasn't an ordinary one: it was a SECURITY GATE. A panel on its left needed three things to work: a SECURITY CARD, POWER RESTORED TO THE AREA, and an access code. Francraft remembered seeing a symbol on a wall where they'd fought the golem. The same symbol was on a wall in the gate room. He told Valentino D. to put his hand on the symbol back where the golem had been. Valentino made his way past the lasers and reached it. He placed his hand on the symbol, and Fran did the same with the other one. While they both held their hands there, a door opened in the gate room. Beyond it, stairs led down, so the friends went downstairs. They found an old room full of cobwebs, with papers stuck to the walls that looked like an old escape plan. Josefina tried to read them, but the writing was too faded. Juan Martín used a flashlight he found on the floor and made out a sentence: “Today I hid my diary where they won't find it. Whoever finds it will know how to escape. The code is 153 ___.” Just then, Juana noticed that the paper was burned. Maybe someone had burned it, Valentino S. thought. They needed another clue. They had the first three digits of the gate's security code, but three were missing: six digits altogether. “Maybe we can use the flashlight to find more writing,” Juan Martín suggested. But he'd left it on while they were thinking. The battery had been low, and now it was dead. They had no other flashlight. How were they supposed to read the papers? Then Tomás realized he had a pen with an infrared light in his pocket. They tried it on one of the papers. Meanwhile, his sister Martina found a card inside an envelope under a table. It was the card they needed to open the gate! They still needed the last three digits and had to restore power to that part of the prison. Then Faricraft found a small opening in a wall, with light coming through. It didn't look like sunlight, but artificial light. After looking around, they found a five-euro coin. That seemed strange: they were in Argentina. Or so they thought. Through the hole, they could see a room with a Spanish flag hanging inside. They'd been taken to Spain without realizing it. The question was how… and when.

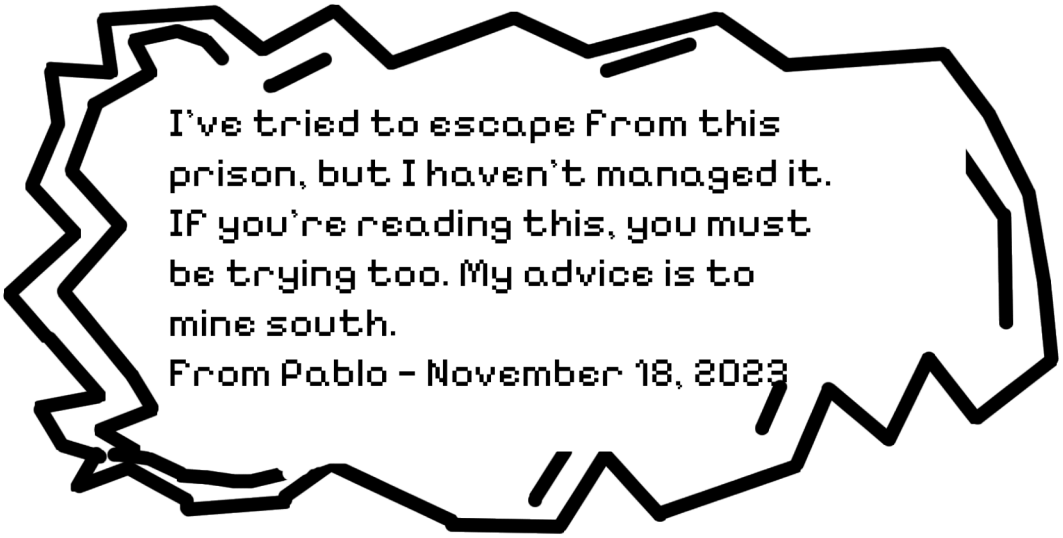
Suddenly, the coin they'd found turned into three STONE PICKAXES. Faricraft, Francraft and Vicencraft mined together until they'd made a hole big enough for 14 people to get through. Inside the room were tables, old papers, keys and LIT CANDLES. That probably meant someone had been there recently, less than two to four hours ago, since that was how long a normal candle lasted. Everyone searched and picked up whatever they could find. Once they'd found two objects, they put them on a table to examine them.



There was a map of the main corridor, which probably wouldn't be much use by now, and a service bell. They didn't think the bell would help either, but Juan Martín kept it. Then Martina noticed an X on the map, on the left side of the corridor. After coming so far, nobody wanted to go through everything again. Martina used her ingenuity to build a robot from parts she found on the floor. They seemed to belong to an old robot built about THREE YEARS ago, but it was smashed to pieces. Strange. She programmed her new robot with artificial intelligence so it could get past the lasers and reach the spot marked on the map. When it arrived, it began searching. Under a floor tile, it found a small METAL REMOTE. It was old and dusty, with only three buttons. The first said “Doors” and the second “Security.” The third had no lettering; it had probably worn off over time. The robot brought the remote to Martina. She checked it, but it didn't seem to work. She was about to put it away to repair later when it suddenly came to life. A message appeared on her robot's screen: “UNIT 03 DETECTED.” Martina handed the remote to Gaspar. Since they'd already opened the doors, he decided to press the Security button. All the prison's security shut down, and a secret door opened in a wall where it had been hidden. Everyone went through and found an EMPTY room… But there was a trick…

CHAPTER 3:
PUTTING IT TO USE

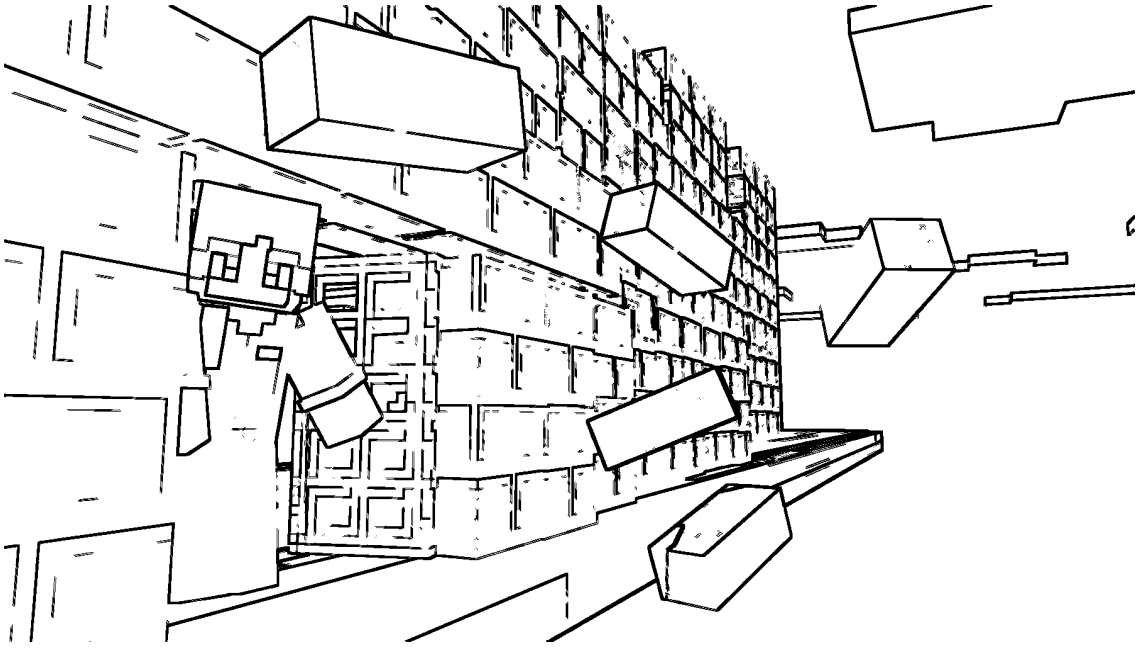
Juan Martín remembered the service bell he'd kept and rang it three times in a row. Suddenly, three digits rose out of the floor. They were probably the missing digits of the GATE CODE. They'd done it! Then Tomás remembered what they still needed: to restore power to the area. They kept searching until they found a letter. It read:



It was dated late 2023, which meant the candle really had been burning for years. There was a compass beside the letter. Using it, Juana, Josefina and Delfina began mining south, as the letter said. When they broke through, they found a steel door. Martina thought it was time to try the unmarked button on the remote. They pressed it, and…

CHAPTER 4:
WHAT FOR?

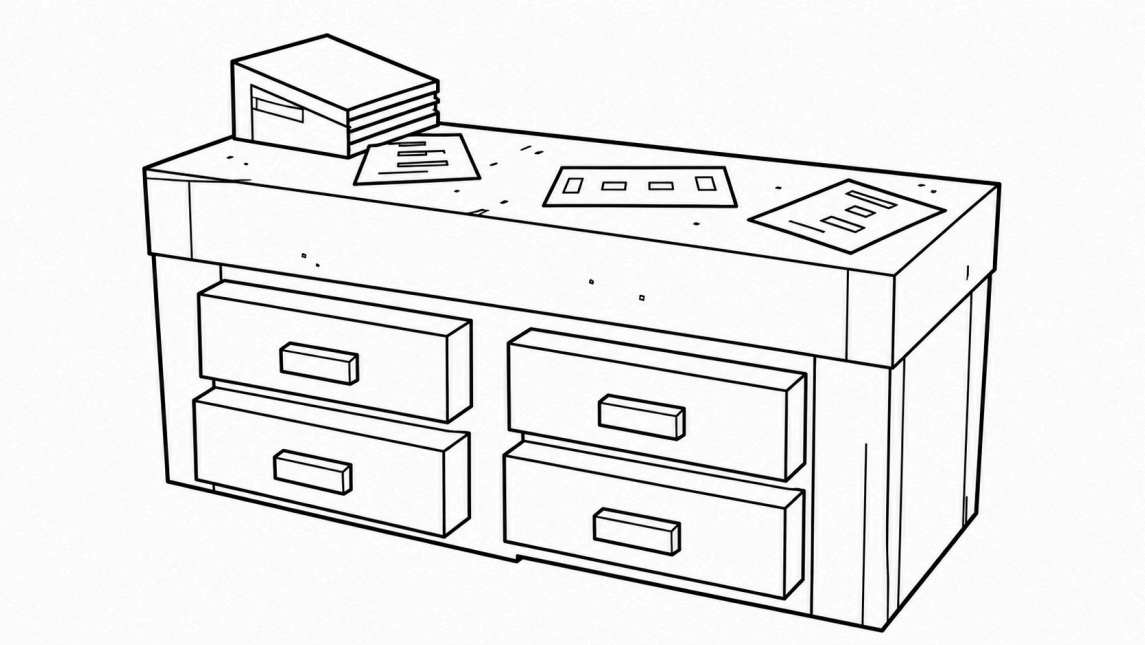
The button opened the steel door. Beyond it was a corridor with lots of labeled doors, but the one at the far end had no sign. The friends began trying them. “There's nothing in here but flying sausages,” Martina said.



After trying door after door, they decided to open the unlabeled one at the end. Behind it was a place that had once belonged to someone. Now it was completely abandoned…

CHAPTER 5:
ABANDONED,
OR IS IT?

It was an apparently abandoned office, full of papers, documents, folders and cobwebs. It was older than it looked…



They searched every drawer and found three copper chains, a diamond ring and two $100 bills. Valentino D., the jewelry expert, examined the chains and the ring. The chains were marked “FB12,” and the ring was marked “FA12.” Then Gaspar checked the bills. Since they were worth $100 each, they were quite valuable, so he decided to keep them.

CHAPTER 6:
SOMETHING WAS STILL MISSING...

They decided to work that out later and went back the way they'd come. This time, they noticed something different.

The steel door they'd come through was open, but that wasn't strange: they'd left it that way. What was different was a set of small marks on the floor that hadn't been there before.

“What are those marks?” Martina asked.

They moved closer and followed them down the corridor. They looked as though something heavy had been dragged along the floor.

“Looks like something came through here while we were in the office,” Juan Martín said.

The marks led to a corner, then disappeared.

Faricraft looked ahead.

“We've got two options, then: follow the marks or go back and look for another way out.”

“I vote we follow them,” Gaspar said.

Everyone agreed, and they continued down the corridor.

A few minutes later, the marks ended in front of a door they hadn't checked before. A small sign on it read:

MAINTENANCE

Martina tried the door. To everyone's surprise, it was unlocked.

Inside, they found tools, cables and some old machines. On a table lay a sheet of paper that looked fairly recent.

Tomás picked it up and read it.

“It says someone was working in this area recently.”

“How recently?” Faricraft asked.

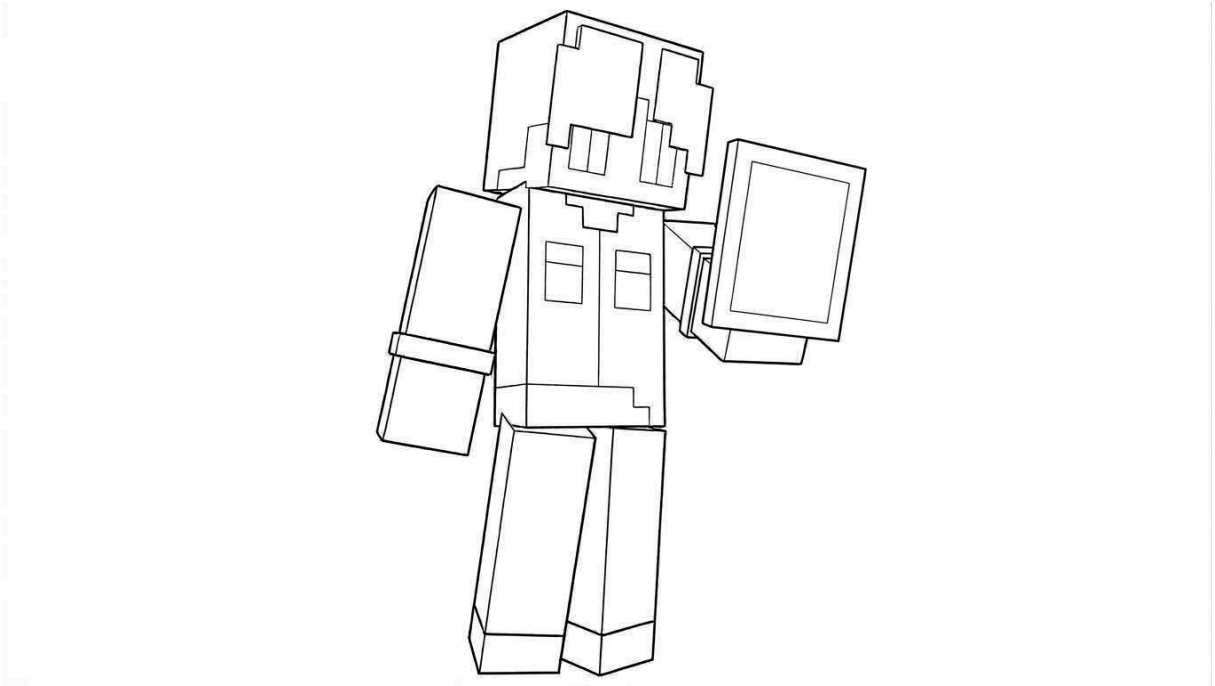
Tomás checked the date.

“Two days ago.”

Everyone fell silent.

The prison looked as though it had been abandoned for years, but someone had been there recently.

And if someone had been there just two days ago, they were probably still nearby.



CHAPTER 7: WAS SOMEONE THERE?

Tomás put the paper on the table and searched the drawers. He found a plan of the prison with an area marked on it that hadn't appeared on the other maps.

“It says ‘Basement’ here,” he explained.

Faricraft looked at it curiously. After searching for a while, they found a door hidden behind a shelving unit. Tomás worked an old machine and managed to unlock it.

Beyond it, stairs led down into darkness.

They went down with their flashlights and reached a metal corridor. At the end was another door, beside a security camera.

Suddenly, a loudspeaker beeped.

“Unauthorized access,” an electronic voice announced.

A heavy door dropped behind them, blocking the stairs.

“Great! Now we're trapped!” Faricraft exclaimed.

The screen beside the door lit up with a message: PERSONNEL DETECTED: 4.

Then a human voice came through the speaker.

“If you want to get out, you'll have to reach the control center. But don't open any other doors.”

“Why?” Tomás asked.

The voice answered in a whisper:

“Because there's something locked up down there.”

The connection went dead.

Suddenly, three knocks came from behind the door.

Bang. Bang. Bang.

Faricraft stepped back as the handle began to turn.

CHAPTER 8: THE MARKS

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CHAPTER 9:
THE SECRET OF THE BASEMENT

Tomás kept searching the drawers and found a plan of the prison. A BASEMENT was marked directly below them. Martina looked behind a shelving unit and found a button. When she pressed it, a door opened onto a staircase. They called the others over and went down together.

Below was a room full of screens and a machine labeled “UNIT 03.” It was the same name that had appeared on Martina's robot. Tomás found some instructions on a table and began reading. The machine controlled the prison, but it was faulty and had cut power to the gate area. That was why they hadn't been able to open it, even with the card and the code.

Gaspar spotted a lever at the side and was about to pull it down, but Tomás stopped him.
“That one cuts the power! We need to lift the other one.”
Gaspar switched levers, and the screens lit up. One showed the gate beside a message: POWER RESTORED. They left the room and went back upstairs to check.

This time, the gate panel worked. Martina swiped the card, and Tomás entered the full code. After a few seconds, the gate began to rise. Beyond it, a path led to a road. The friends ran through and didn't stop until they were far from the entrance. At last, they'd escaped from the prison. While the others looked for a way onward, Gaspar checked his pockets and pulled out the two bills he'd found in the office.
“Well, at least we didn't leave empty-handed,” he said.

THE END.